

Mission to England and Return, 1854 – 1857

In **August, 1854**, I left on a mission to England. I went to Pittsburg and from there to Philadelphia where I met Bro. Walker, another missionary, and we visited the saints. Bro. Winters was very kind to me and gave me \$5.00, a fine pair of boots and got up a farewell party and invited a number of saints to a symptous supper.

On **September 22nd**, Bro. Walker and I left Philadelphia on board a steamboat for New York. We decided to sail on the fine sailing vessel "Constitution" to Liverpool and paid our passage by the "steerage," eight dollars each and found our own provisions.

The steam tug towed the ship as far as the floating lights then left us to wind our way over the great Atlantic by wind and sail. No sooner than the steamer left us than the wind began to blow a brisk breeze and the noble vessel began to rock. I commenced to be seasick and continued so for the first week.

We arrived at Liverpool **October 15th**, making a speedy and successful voyage from New York to Liverpool in 18 days. A man was found dead in the hold of the ship who was supposed to have stowed away at New York and some cotton bales had moved upon him as the cargo had moved.

On **September 16th** a tender took the passengers and luggage from the ship to the Custom House. After dinner at a restaurant we walked to 15 Wilton Street and were warmly received by Bro. Franklin D. Richards and several others in the office. Bro. Richards said I must buy me some new clothes and he would lend me the money to pay for them and then I could go and visit my relatives.

I bought a complete new outfit of excellent clothes. I first went in Cheshire and saw my dear Mother was was spending some time at Mr. and Mrs. A. Davenport's who lived at the "Oaklands" a most magnificent place, as Mr. Davenport, my cousin, was a wealthy and independent gentleman.

Mother was delighted to see me again after spending a few days I went to Birmingham to see my brother Richard who was a merchant doing a large and prosperous business. When I first left Birmingham in 1850 he predicted that I would return in rags and tatters like the prodigal son but in this he found himself very much mistaken.

When I entered his place of business as soon as he saw me he took me by the hand and was so overcome by emotion that he could not speak, however, he soon sent the porter for a cab and accompanied me to his fine residence some three miles distant and both he and Mrs. Lunt and children were exceedingly glad to see me and treated me very kind.

The next morning I accompanied my brother in an omnibus to his mercantile establishment in town, from my appearance being so well dress'd and having a handsome little trunk, which Bro. Walters of Philadelphia kindly made me a present of and a neat little finger ring that was gave me in Saint Louis, I think my brother had an idea that I had been to the gold mines in California and had become rich and had seen the error of my ways in joining the "Mormons" and had come back to stay.

Just as we were about to enter his store he said to me "Well, Henry, what are you going to do now you have come back?" I said I have returned a missionary Elder of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints to preech the Gospel without purse or scrip, why, said he, have you got no money? I said I have a few shillings in my pocket, that's all. He went into the counting house and opened the safe and took a new five pound Bank of England note and ten new half sovereigns and put into my hand. I thank'd him and put it in my pocket. I had no sooner done so when a very different spirit took possession of him and he made use of very bad language about the "Mormons." I wished him good morning and thought I would call again when he would feel to be himself again. I went to the Post Office and got a money order for six pounds and sent to Bro. Franklin D. Richards at Liverpool to pay him back for the money he lent me to pay for my clothes, feeling very thankful to our Heavenly Father for opening up my way so soon and unexpectedly.

I spent about one month in visiting relatives in Cheshire, Staffordshire and Birmingham and bore a faithful testimony to them all of the Truth of the work of God. My dear Mother gave me a sovereign, my sister, Jamima, gave me five shillings and my brother Richard gave me another sovereign, also Mr. George Peter Hale gave me a sovereign.

While in Birmingham I call'd to see my brother John who was living there at that time and when there my old sweetheart, Martha Bristol, called to see her sister, she had married a merchant by the name of Husband. While we were both glad to see each other I very much regretted to see that she felt very unhappy. She invited me to go and see her but I did not think it was wise for me to do so. During a subsequent visit at my brother John's his wife, Mrs. Husband's sister, told me that her sister, Martha, had fretted and cried considerable since she saw me and her husband told her that she had better go back with her old Mormon sweetheart and he would give her 500 pounds to go with. I never saw her but that one time during my whole mission in England.

On **November 15th** my brother Richard invited me to dine with him at 3 o'clock and granted me the privilege of taking a friend with me and I took Elder Israel Barlow with me who was the Pastor of the Birmingham Conference, a most excellent dinner was provided.

My sister-in-law, Mrs. John Lunt, was present. Mr. and Mrs. Samuel Tromer were invited but Mr. Tromer would neither come or let his wife and said he did not want her to be in my company. Bro. Barlow and myself spent the evening and staid all night and were very kindly treated. A few days previous I received a letter of appointment from President Franklin D. Richards to labor in the South conference under the Presidency of Pastor Chauncy G. Webb. The next day Bro. Barlow accompanied me to the railway station and I took my departure for Bristol.

On the **22nd of November** I left Bristol and went to Taunton, a very beautiful and clean little town of some 15,000 inhabitants and the county seat of Somerset. I made my principle home with Bro. Robert Taylor and family. Bro. Robert Taylor held the office of a Deacon and he was the only man in the Taunton branch who held the Priesthood; consequently, my duties were very numerous having to do the singing, praying, preaching and administering of the Sacrament at the meetings.

The Taunton branch was raised up by Elder Wm. C. Dunbar and had but a few members of the church scattered through a large district of country. The clergymen and sectarian ministers in the town published and circulated two pamphlets against the Latter Day Saints. They held a counsel and wanted me to be put out of town and waited upon the head Church of England Minister soliciting his assistance but he told them he would have nothing to do with it.

I felt very humble and prayerful during my labors in this district and baptised eight new members into the church and labored there but one month when I received an appointment from Pres. Franklin D. Richards to preside over the South conference. I must mention a remarkable case of healing. Bro. & Sister Charles Barrell of Taunton had a child born with one of its eyes much deformed, the lower part of the eye lid hanging down which look'd very bad, feeling very sorry for the child I took it up in my arms. I walked round the room several times praying over it. The next morning to the joy and satisfaction of the parents the childs eye was natural and all right.

I found most of the Saints in Bristol very poor and the conference very much in debt to the Liverpool office for books. On making a close investigation through the conference, I could not find a single person that could emigrate even as far as the United States to say nothing of going through to Utah.

Bro. Atwood and I walked to the City of Bath and then on to visit the branches in Devonshire. I walked 80 miles during the past week. There was a good sized branch of the church in South Molton and as there were some difficulties existed, my visit was much needed and much good was done. When I had walked to Barnstable, 12 miles from South Molton, I took off my shoes and found my socks quite wet with blood through walking so much. I traveled on foot for several hundred miles during the

months following, visiting many small branches and preaching the gospel when an opportunity offered some of the time in company with Pastor Millen Atwood and at other times with some of the traveling Elders.

On **January 24th, 1856** I went in company with Bro. Atwood to Leeds, 100 miles. On the 26th we had both of photoes taken together and framed to be presented to the saints at Bristol to be hung up in the meeting house. Also I had a small one taken which I presented to Bro. Atwood to be put in a finger ring.

Left Leeds same day with Bro. Atwood and W. G. Young for Hull. While in Hull I met with quite a number who were well acquainted with my dear brother, Thomas, who was the youngest child in our family. He lived in Hull for some few years in business. In looking over the records of the Hull branch of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints, I found my brothers name recorded as being baptized by Elder Hugh Findley April 27, 1851 and confirmed by him on the same day.

I went to see Mr. Cook who bought my brothers business and paid him twelve hundred pounds for it (about six thousand dollars). He spoke in the very best manner of my brother and said that they agreed in the transaction of their business and never had a jar. He said my brother was an honest, honorable, upright young man. He said my brother did not feel altogether well satisfied in starting for Australia and the night before he left his residence, he, like Joseph of old, wept aloud. He said that when the news came that the ship was wrecked, his store was crowded for several weeks, making all enquiry and every one seem'd to greatly lament his death.

I will here say that my brother's wife was bitterly opposed to Mormonism and his intention was to go to Australia and from thence to California and from there to me. We were more attached to each other than any other two in the family.

He sail'd from Liverpool for Australia on the New Iron clipper built sailing vessel on the 19th of January, 1854, and the ship was wrecked in the Irish Channel about 13 miles from Dublin on the 21st of the same month when 400 souls perished out of 600. My brother had his wife and son, David, 8 years old and servant girl along. I was informed by my brother, Richard, that a short time before the dreadful calamity that my brother Thomas came up out of the Saloon cabin and addressed a gentleman by the name of Cutts as follows: "Mr. Cutts this ship will be wrecked. At the same time (taking some insurance papers from his side coat pocket) you will be saved but I will be drowned and I want you to give these papers to my brother Richard of Birmingham."

Mr. Cutts did so, showing that my poor brother's prediction had its liberal fulfilment.

A sister Greensides of Hull gave me a Book of Mormon which belonged to my brother, Thomas, which I very much prized.

The following is a copy of the Testimonial heretofore mentioned:

A Testimonial presented to Henry Lunt on his departure from the South conference to take the Pastoral charge of the Newcastle upon Tyne Carlisle and Durham Conferences. Beloved President. As you have been called upon by the Servants of God to leave this for another field of labor, We the officers and members of the South Conference over which you have presided during the past year cannot allow this opportunity to pass without presenting you with this small testimonial of our love and esteem. Coming amongst us as you did fresh from the bosom of the church you infused into us the spirit of Zion which raised us from the dead and lukewarm state, into which we had fallen, into the Gospel of Jesus. During the whole of the time you have presided over us, this wisdom of your councils have been manifested by their successful operation. Your zeal and devotedness of purpose in rolling forth the work of God, regardless of personal comfort has called forth our admiration, while your childlike simplicity and kindness has begot in us a deep root of love that will [not be] erased with memory and we most cordially recommend you to the Saints who you are now called to take the Pastoral charge and we pray God to grant you a rich portion of His Holy Spirit to enable you to fulfill out a more extensive sphere of usefulness, to be a blessing to many and at last be crowned in a Celestial Glory for Christs sake, Amen.

On **October the 20th**, I attended the Sheffield conference by invitation of Elder Wm. G. Young afterwards attended the Nottingham conference by invitation of Apostle Ezra T. Benson, after which we went to Birmingham. We visited my dear old Mother at Mount Pleasant Staffordshire and laid our hands upon her head and blest her, Bro. Benson being mouth. On my return to my field of labor, I received the Star containing a list of releases and appointments and found the welcome news of my being released to return home the following year. Elder Wm. J. Smith of the 71st ward, Salt Lake City, was appointed to succeed me. I took him to most of the travelers in the three conferences to introduce him to the Saints. Bro. Dan Weigeland, a member of the church from Norway, and an Artist volunteer'd to paint my portrait in oil colors which he did and kindly presented it to me. It was exhibited in a picture shop window for some time and was said to be worth ten pounds.

I can truly say that I labored assiduously in the Newcastle upon Tyne Carlisle and Durham Conferences during the year 1856 as Pastor and was greatly blest of the Lord. A great many were added to the church by baptism and the sum of six hundred pounds were rais'd from volunteer contributions principally and some by tithing which liquidated a large book debt at Liverpool swelling the Temple and emigration funds and

other purposes. All the tithing money was sent to the President of the European Mission at Liverpool.

I visited my old field of labor, viz. the South conference and had a very enjoyable time after which I attended the Birmingham conference held in the Oddfellow's Hall, after which I went to London in response to an invitation from Apostle Ezra T. Benson, who was quite sick. I administered to him and he immediately began to recover. By Bro. Benson's request I spent several weeks with him in London visiting the numerous branches and many of the families of the Saints and seeing the many wonderful sights, among which was Sydenham Crystol Palace, the House of Lords and House of Commons, her majesties stables at Buckingham Palace, The Lyseum Theatre, etc. etc.

Sunday, January 8th, 1857. After attending a Priesthood meeting at Camdintown London, Orson Pratt, Bro. Wm. Budge and myself were invited by Bro. George Teasdale to accompany him to his residence and dine with him. After my visit to London I returned and visited Bath, Bristol and South Wales and my relatives and friends in Birmingham, Staffordshire and Cheshire from there to Manchester, Hywood, Bolton and other place in Lancashire, Liverpool, Preston, Carlisle, Newcastle upon Lyne and Sunderland and Durham Conferences.

I received the following lines from Sister Mary Ann Wilson of Carlisle, inscribed to Mrs. Henry Lunt:

A Similitude

***In Ephraim's Vale, A floweret bloom'd Surpassing lovely was its hue;
It spread its fragrance all around The pleasant spot on which it grew,***

***Yet so lovely and so sweet, Twas full of grace and modesty
And strove to hide it's loveliness, From the rude gaze of passer's by.***

***But there was one of beauteous form Of graceful mein and noble birth
Who chance'd to see its tiny head And not because in georgeous tints
Of dazzling beauty 'twas array'd But for the unassuming grace
That threw a halo round its head***

***But when he saw its tender stem And thought on storms that might arise
And blight its lovely beauteous bloom He gently plucked the dear lov'd prize***

***And in his bosom safely placed This sweet and fragrant flower.
And there it blooms secure from harm And every blighting power***

This flower an emblem is, of her Who is the hope, the joy, the life,

Of one of Israel's noblest sons His dear and fondly cherished wife

*O still may she in beauty bloom And dwell in peace and sweet content
And bless with pure devoted love Her honr'd Husband, Henry Lunt.*

Dedicated to Pastor Henry Lunt on his departure for Utah by Elder Thomas Wallace.

Farewell dear brother, Father, Friend
The parting hour at last hath come
In Britain's land we must remain
While you to Zion gather home.

Peace to that home, joy to that heart
And every heart thou hold'st most dear,
Oh may thou ever act thy part
As thou has nobly acted here.

Thy counsels pure, thy actions mild
Thy bold defense of sterling truth
Have won for thee the warm esteem
Of old grey hairs and tender youth.

Could we have longer shared the bliss,
The joy and peace thy presence gives
We'd further learn Salvations plan
And know how Saints of God should live

We speak what we have felt and seen
The pen's the servant of the heart
And when we contemplate thy worth
Our souls feel pain'd since we must part

God bless thee on thy journey home
May angels guard thee night and day
And peace thy boon companion be
Sincerely still for thee we'll pray

Hope lifts the veil of future years
And bids us rest awhile in peace
E'er long in Babel's Towns and vales
Our toils like thine will surely cease

We'll gladly follow where you lead
To Zion's Holy Mountain home
Where none but upright saints will live
When Christ shall to his Temple come.

Farewell, once more we say farewell
Our hearts are full, tears fill each eye
One friendly grasp, one parting look
We part the bosom heaves a sigh.

We feel a friend to us is lost
But others share the boon that's gone
Our Sun though set may rise again
And glad the earth it shone upon.

I was traveling in England with Bro. E. T. Benson attending various conferences until the 25th of April when I arrived in Liverpool just barely in time to go on board the sailing ship "Westmoreland" which had moved out of dock into the river. It was thought by Pres. Orson Pratt that I would not be in Liverpool in time to go on this ship or I would have been appointed President. Consequently, Mathias Cowley was appointed and myself and Bro. Lillenquist were appointed Counsellors.

There were 539 Scandinavian Saints on board and 575 souls altogether. Captain Decan was exceedingly kind to me, very often inviting me to eat with him in the cabin and spent much of my time with him chatting and reading. The saints were organized into four wards with a president over each. I suffered some from sea sickness during most of the voyage. Saw many ships during our passage. We arrived at Philadelphia on Sunday afternoon, the last day in May, thus making the voyage in five weeks and one day from Liverpool. The captain expressed himself as highly pleased with the good order and conduct of our people. I went ashore from the ship with several of the brethren and went to see bro. Angus M. Cannon who was presiding over the church in Philadelphia.

We left Philadelphia in a special train on the **2nd of June** on the Baltimore and Ohio Railroad, fare being Ten and a half dollars for adults and half fare under twelve and under six free. We traveled via Chicago, Baltimore and many other places of interest and arrived at Iowa City on the 9th of June where we met James A. Little and a number of other Elders at the camping ground. Myself and Bro. Cowley left the emigrant train at Rock Island and took an Express trail to Iowa City to prepare matters for the emigrant train which arrived about 5 P.M.

On the **12th of June** a number of the Saints started out with hand carts, being evening they traveled but three miles and camped. The next day I, Bro. Little and several others

went out and organized them by appointing Elder James P. Park captain of the handcart company; D. B. Dilly captain of the first 200 persons and bro. Lorenzo D. Rudd captain of the 2nd 200 persons. Bro. Christianson C[l]erk and Bro. Lillenquist interpreters. On leaving the camp I stood up in a wagon and swung my hat and gave three cheers for the handcart company and said God bless them which was responded to by a tremendous and loud amen by all the company. I had very peculiar feelings in seeing them start and could scarcely refrain from shedding tears as well as laughing, for it was certainly a very peculiar sight – such a one that I never saw before and truly I felt like asking our Heavenly Father to bless them as they had a journey of some twelve hundred miles before them, having to wade many rivers and cross the plains only inhabited by wild Indians, the Buffalo and wild beasts.

On **Monday, the 5th of June**, I left camp in company with Elder James Little per railway for St. Louis for the purpose of purchasing supplies for to fit out the companies of saints at Florence on the Missouri river near to Old Winter quarters. We staid at Muscatine until 11 PM when we went on board the U.S. mail steamboat "Ben Campbell" and resumed our journey on the Mississippi River. We past Nauvoo next morning on the eastern banks of the river and as I gazed on the remains of the once beautiful Temple and the houses which were built by the industry of the saints, now inhabited by wicked gentiles, the Temple which was built and dedicated to the Lord now laying in ruins, one end only standing, I reflected on the times that were past and the persecutions of the saints and then again on the future with the satisfaction of knowing that the Lord will avenge the wrongs of His people and the blood of his servants which has been shed by wicked men.

As I was deeply meditating over the above named scenes, am standing on the hurricane deck looking at the famed city, as the boat glides down the father of waters one of the cabin passengers came and stood by my side and commenced talking about Nauvoo and the "Mormons." He said Brigham Young and all the leaders deserved to be kill'd off and manifested the same hellish spirit in him as did the demons who persecuted and slew the saints in days of Joseph. The first opportunity I had I resorted to a place which was about as high as I could get being by the Pilothouse I took off my hat and offered up a prayer unto Israels God for this said man and all such enemies to God's people. Staid four hours at Keokuk and went on board the beautiful steamboat Keokuk and arrived at St. Louis next day at 11 A.M. where we met with Elder Horace Eldredge and several brethren.

Next day, **June 18th, 1857** twenty-five brethren arrived from Utah on missions to the States, Europe and Africa. They reported 50 others who had not arrived in St. Louis. The whole of them crossed the plains with handcarts and appeared healthy and strong and appeared in excellent spirits.

While in St. Louis I assisted Bro. Little in transacting business for the emigration of the saints over the plains after which I left St. Louis on board the steamboat "S. A. Ogden" for Florence, Nebraska territory in charge of a number of saints who had steerage passage and 59,615 lb. of freight. The captain gave me a saloon cabin passage free. The river was rising very fast, current so strong that we made but slow progress. Mr. Douglass, the clerk, told me that last night that in a distance of 20 miles on the Missouri river we passed no less than 32 sunken steamboats which had been wrecked by running against snags.

While we were taking in wood at a wood yard the steamboat "Oceana" came up with 200 U.S. Troops aboard and a quantity of mules and wagons. I was informed that they were bound for Fort Leavenworth, thence to Salt Lake City and that there were 3000 going there to protect the new governor "Alfred Cummings" and enable him to enforce the law. Much excitement has been raised against the Mormons by the evil and lying reports of Judge Drummond and others of the U.S. officers who have returned from Utah because they were not allowed to practice sin and iniquity. Arrived at Florence June 30th. From the 10th of June till the 12th of July, 1857, I was very busy hauling freight from the steamboat to the warehouse and dealing out provisions to the emigrants and otherwise assisting them, and attending several preaching and counsel meetings.

I started this morning, **July 12th**, in company with some fifty other brethren and sisters for Salt Lake Valley. There were nineteen wagons in the company, all ox teams. I had two yoke of cattle and one wagon and three passengers with their luggage and provisions which consisted of sister Sinclair (a widow) and her daughter, Jane Sinclair. Sister Sinclair was a very worthy woman from North Shields, her husband was a sea captain. She and her daughter had come as far as Florence but for want of means could not proceed any further and as she had been very generous in entertaining the Elders for many years I felt it to be my duty to assist them by taking them with me. The brother passenger's name was Richard Newness who gave me forty dollars for his passage and provisions. Bro. Newness and I slept on the ground under the wagon all the distance of a thousand miles over the plains and Widow Sinclair and her daughter slept on my feather bed in the wagon. We encountered many heavy thunder storms during the journey over the plains and sometimes the water would run under our bed under the wagon. We camp'd on the Big Pappio Creek the first night from Florence and effected an organization, of which I was Chaplain.

July 19th. We crossed the river in the afternoon, which is a very difficult stream to cross owing to the quicksand. We had to hitch from 6 to 8 yoke of cattle to each wagon. We all got over safe by about dark. I waded seven times which is about half a mile wide with a very swift current.

July 31st. During the last five days we have seen an immense quantity of Buffalos. The Platte valley has been litterly black with them. We were compelled to stop our train a number of times for them to get out of the way as we were fearful of our cattle becoming frightened and stampeding. Once a very large bull buffalo was alone behind the main herd of several thousand head which had just cross'd the south fork of the Platte and came on a loap going west after the herd and but for me firing a shot at him in the head from my revolver which turned him close by the hind end of the wagon, he would have bounded between my two yoke of oxen and being the last wagon that day in the train providently avoided serious results.

August 7th. Camped near to a very large camp of Sioux Indians. The chief and many of his braves visited us in the evening and were very friendly. They sat down on the ground forming a large circle. We gave them some crackers, sugar and tobacco. I explained to them the best I could through gestures, etc. and told them that we were Mormons and their true friends and by and by Indians and Mormons would be one and that they would not be oppress'd and driven as they and the Mormons had been. They appeared to understand considerable and much pleased, so much so that the chief put his arms round my neck and saluted me with a kiss.

On the **9th of August**, drove about seven miles and camp'd as the day was very hot. Some Government officers pass'd on the south fork of the Platte. A few of our brethren went over to talk to them but could not learn much only that they were going ahead of their train of supplies that was behind them. About this time green headed flies and misquitos were very annoying to both man and beast.

On the **12th of August** we pass'd the grave of one of our Danish brethren. The wolves having dug up the body which made it a frightful sight to behold.

21st of August we cross'd the Platte opposite Fort Laramie and camp'd in the evening where we met Bro. Samuel W. Richards and Bro. Snyder who were on their way to Liverpool as Missionaries. There were several other brethren along. We held a very pleasant meeting.

August 23rd. We met Bro. Parks with four yoke of oxen to render assistance to those who most needed it. We camped near to the station on Horseshoe creek; there are some half dozen log houses erected here with an excellent corral for the purpose of forming a station on the line between Salt Lake and Missouri River for the benefit of a carrying company which had been organized in Salt Lake City by Pres. Brigham Young call'd the Y X Company. It would have evidently been a most excellent thing if the U.S. Government had let us alone, but as Uncle Sam is sending of 4000 troops to Salt Lake with the intention of killing and destroying the Saints of God. But Pres. Young was determined that they should not have their own way in that matter. In consequence, of

this army coming Pres. Young gave orders to vacate all the stations and burn the houses and corrals. We held a meeting in the evening with Bro. Bennett and the brethren who return'd with us to Salt Lake.

August 28th. We camp'd at Deer Creek where we found seventy of our brethren and another large station. Nathaniel V. Jones was the captain here. The whole of the brethren left with us next morning. They had twenty eight horses and ox teams.

September 2nd. We passed Devils Gate Station where we staid some 6 hours. There were a number of brethren camp'd here from Salt Lake City who Pres. Brigham Young had sent to act as a Guard for the Emigration and defend them from the soldiers who were on their way. Traveled some eight miles and camp'd on the Sweetwater.

September 7th. Traveled about 10 miles and camp'd on the Sweetwater. I took a long walk with my gun down the river, shot a jack rabbit. Saw some very interesting and romantic scenery. I had many pleasing reflections while traveling alone in this sequestered and remote part of the earth where the footprints of a white man is seldom seen and all nature appears as though nothing had been molested since it rolled out of the Hands of the Creator.

September 8th. We traveled 25 miles. While nooning near the last crossing of the Sweetwater we met Bros. Bennet and Holly came up as they were taking an express to Salt Lake on horseback. They told us that they had been back as far as Fort Laramie as spies to see how far the Gov't Troops were on the way. They pretended they were gold diggers returning from California to the States and that met several hundred of the troops and went into their camp and conversed freely with several of the officers, said they were going to Salt Lake and would hang Brigham Young and Heber C. Kimball and others that they had got with writs for and they swore and cursed and boasted of what great things they should do when they got there, but they will find their boasting is in vain long before they get there.

September 14th. Met several brethren from Salt Lake with thirty nine yoke of oxen which Pr. Young had sent to help our Emigration in. Arrived at Fort Bridger about 9 P.M. Laid over the next day shoeing oxen and in the evening Captain Van Vliet of the U.S. Army who had been to see President Young arrived in company with Dr. Bernhisch, O. P. Rockwell, N. V. Jones and several other brethren who came with the captain and Dr. Bernhisch as an escort as far as the Gov't Camp on Harns Fork.

September 18th. W. G. Young and company arrived about noon, and the next morning we all started together for Salt Lake City where we arrived on the 25th. There were 30 wagons in the company. I was invited to put up at Ezra Benson's house and supper was immediately prepared, to which myself and Bro. Martin did ample justice. Vegetables

and peach pies were indeed a great luxury which those only can fully appreciate who have been traveling for several months over the desert plains encountering heat and dust. After supper I accompanied Bro. Martin to his Mother-In-Laws, sister Moor's in the 19th Ward, where I met with Sister Mary Ann Wilson, a very worthy and intelligent young lady, who came from England in my Pastorate this year. Sister Martin went into the garden and fetched a milk pan full of peaches of the finest kind and set them before me, expressing a desire for me to help myself freely to all I could eat which truly I did and by no means sparingly. After several hours in chatting together and rejoicing in each other's company, I retired to sister Benson's to rest on a good feather bed which was a great luxury especially when contrasted to sleeping on the hard ground under the wagon on the plains for nearly three months.

September 26. I went to report myself to Prest. Young. He bid me welcome home. I had an agreeable interview of about two hours with him. He said "well, Bro. Henry, go and rest yourself and get ready to go again." Notwithstanding the bold step he had taken in repelling the United States Army from entering Salt Lake valley which was sent by James Buchannon with malicious intentions towards the Latter Day Saints, based upon false reports by Judge Drummond, I never before saw him look so cheerful and happy, his countenance beamed and look'd Heavenly, lit up by the Spirit of God, whose church he is presiding over upon the earth and may he live to see his enemys wasted away like the dew before the morning sun.

Sunday, September 27th. Attended meeting. I was the first of the returned missionaries to be called upon to speak. At the close of the meeting Bro. Woodruff invited me to go and dine with him. Arrapine, the Utah chief also accompanied us. Bro. Woodruff took me through his orchard which was well stocked with a great variety of fruit trees which were loaded so heavy that many of them had to be supported with props.

September 29th. Sister Mary Ann Wilson came to see me and we had a very pleasant and agreeable interview. I have devined a noble spirit of integrity, faith and virtue in Sister Wilson which has manifested itself in her walk and conversation ever since I first became acquainted with her, which was in June, 1856, in Carlisle, England. At the close of the conference held there at that time she came to me and express'd her satisfaction with what she heard me preach. She said it appeared to her that I had been acquainted with all she had been anxious to know for some time as I had answered every inquiry of her mind. She was afterwards baptized at Dalston near to Carlisle on the 27th of July, 1856, by Elder Thos. Adams. She was born in Carlisle, January 19, 1834. Her mother died January 20, 1837 at which time she went to live with her father's mother. At the death of her Mother, her father traveled from one place to another until he finally settled in Edinburgh where he obtain'd a living as a tailor. Her uncle, Richard Wilson, was the principle means of giving her a good education and for the last five or six years she obtain'd her living by keeping a day school in Carlisle. In obedience to my counsel she

had a sale and sold off all her household effects, paid her debts and had four pounds, ten shillings left which was sent to Liverpool for her emigration. She sail'd from Liverpool March 28th on board the "George Washington" which had 817 souls of the saints on board bound for Boston. I gave her two pounds ten shillings to pay her railway fare through the states and put her in charge of George Swindle, who agree'd to furnish her a passage over the plains. Bro. & Sister Swindle proved themselves to be true and faithful to Sister Wilson and were very kind to her and spoke in the highest terms of her as being a most amiable young woman and very industrious and agreeable company doing all in her power to make them comfortable. Sister Wilson inform'd me that she walked all the way across the plains with the exception of a few hours ride one day.

October 1st. The Deseret Territorial Fair commenced today in the Tithing office. I paid a visit and was much interested. There was a very good exhibit of manufactured articles, of fruits and vegetables. A brass band was in attendance which discoursed good music which rendered the occasion quite lively and cheerful. There was also a good exhibit of stock.

October 3rd. Eat supper in company with Sister Wilson at Sister Bathsheba Smith, wife of Apostle Geo. A. Smith. His wife, Zilpha, from Parowan was with us and I made her a present of a woolen scarf shawl for her many acts of kindness to me while in Parowan.

October 4th. Attended meeting at the Bowery, in company with Miss Wilson were invited to dine with Bro. Wm. Jennings and family, where we had a most sumptuous and elegant dinner.

Monday, October 5th. My father-in-law, Bro. James Whittaker, arrived from Cedar City, Iron County with my beloved wife, Ellen. He came with a light covered wagon and a yoke of oxen and made the journey, 280 miles, in the extraordinary short space of time of nine days. We were both glad to see each other, especially were Ellen and I pleased to see each others faces again in the flesh after an absence of three and a half years. Our feelings can be better imagined than described. The unspeakable pleasure I enjoyed in my wife and father and with my brethren and sisters in Salt Lake on my return seem'd to more than repay me for my long absence.

October 6th. The Semi-Annual general conference of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints convened in the Bowery at 10 A.M. at which I attended in company with my wife, her father and sister Mary Ann Wilson both morning and afternoon.

October 7th. Attended conference again at the close of the morning's meeting I asked Pres. Young if I could have the privilege of having a young woman sealed to me. He said come to my office with her in about one hours time. Accordingly I went at the time

mentioned with my wife, Ellen and her father and sister Wilson to Pres. Young's office and he conducted us upstairs into a very nice room and sealed Mary Ann Wilson to me for time and all eternity. I thanked him and gave him five dollars which he accepted. He then took my hand in both of his and made me a present of the same five dollars and said "God Bless You." I thanked the Lord our heavenly father for giving me another of his handmaidens to wife and I pray that we may both prove faithful and true to our God and each other and keep sacred the solemn covenants which we have made and have peace, love and union always to abide in our habitation and children to grow up round our table like olive branches that shall become mighty for the Truth's sake in the Kingdom of our God. Conference closed in the afternoon.

October 8th. Pres. Young sealed Miss Catherine Winchester, late of Bristol to father Whittaker. The following two days we spent in visiting a number of our old friends including Pres. Brigham Young and family, with whom we eat supper. They treated us to peaches and grapes and gave us some to eat on our way home.

October 11th. We bid adieu to Salt Lake City and started on our way for Cedar City in Iron County where we arrived all safe on the 27th and were greeted with a hearty welcome by our many old friends. Bro. James Haslam, Captain of the Brass Band, with his brethren serenaded us in the evening with music and staid until a late hour.

Short Entries for 1858 and 1859

January 29th, 1858. I was appointed by the authorities of the stake to [go] on a preaching mission to the Settlements down South in Dixie in company with some other brethren. We held meetings at Fort Harmony & Washington (which was call'd the cotton farm), some 30 miles distance from Harmony. There were some 30 families at this place. The climate very warm and pleasant. Saw several of the sisters wearing cloth from the cotton raised here. The next day we went to Santa Clara an Indian Missionary Station. By request I sang several songs. The next day we return'd to Harmony. In the morning when we left Washington it was so warm for ten miles that we had to ride in our shirt sleeves, but before we got over the Black Ridge we encountered a severe snow storm with a heavy north wind and it was with difficulty that we kept from freezing. I was so num'd when we got to Harmony that I could not dismount from the mule without assistance. Reached home in Cedar City on the 3rd of February where I staid until I went to Parowan on the 13th.

March 30th. The mail arrived from Salt Lake City and brought a circular containing instructions from Pres. Brigham Young to the saints. The main substance of the circular was to the effect that the Saints must leave Salt Lake City and all the settlements north and go as far as Provo for the present and prepare their houses and improvements to be

burned and laid in ashes rather than the army should come in to enjoy them. The saints in this and all the other southern settlements are call'd upon to send teams to assist in the removal of the poor, machinery, etc.

April 10th. I was appointed recorder and auditor of public accounts by the City Council.

During the spring of 1858 a number of horse teams were sent to San Bernardino in California to assist in moving the brethren and their families back to Utah.

July 25th. Amasa Lyman and Geo. A. Smith came to Cedar and preached principally on the necessity of home manufacture and that before this people could become a rich and independent people they would have to quit running to Gentile stores.

September 11th. I was elected a member of the City Council.

November 1st, 1858. Attended a meeting of the Deseret Iron Company held in the company's store. The report showed that the works have been attended with less success this year than ever and yet an immense amount of labor and means has been expended. A letter has been lately received from Pres. Brigham Young directing the works to be stopped, which was addressed to Isaac Haight, manager of the works. The manager's salary it appears has been fifteen hundred dollars a year and that of the secretary, C. J. Arthur, one thousand dollars a year. Considerable means was furnished by the Tithing office and Store goods sent by the church from Salt Lake had been used by the general managements to a great extent, when many of the laborers who performed the hard work have received but little in consequence of which many became discouraged and left for other places to better their condition as this is considered a poor place for farming.

During the remainder of the year and until **February, 1859**, I was very busily engaged, principally as a home missionary and many other duties when on the 21st of February I accompanied Pres. Isaac Haight on a preaching mission to the southern settlements. Visited Harmony, Toquerville, Washington and Virgin City, together with Santa Clara. Arrived home on the **1st of March, 1859.**

During my absence while in England on a mission, Pres. B. Young and Co. made his annual visit through the settlements south of Salt Lake and while in Cedar by his direction another town site was surveyed on the bench near to the mouth of the canyon as he did not consider the old fort site safe from floods as coal creek was subject to very high water in time of flood.

I bought a little Pihede Indian boy about 4 or 5 years old from an old Parvan Chief. I gave him an old rifle, a sack of flour, a shirt and an old pair of pants. We gave him the name of Ammon.

About this time I bought a house and lot in the new city and on the 6th of April moved into it from the old fort.

On **Sunday, the 31st of July, 1859**, Apostle Geo. A. Smith drove up to my house about noon, dined with us and at two o'clock attended meeting. After the usual exercises he arose and said "The President has instructed me to come and disorganize this Stake of Zion and to make a Bishop and President out of one man, and I nominate Bro. Henry Lunt as that man," which was seconded by several voices when Bro. Smith put it to vote which was unanimous. Bro. Smith then invited me to him and placed his hands upon my head and ordain'd me a Bishop and to preside over the Cedar City Ward. I can truly say that I felt my inability to fulfill this high and important trust, yet I know that the Lord is able by his spirit to qualify His servants to do anything he calls them to do if they will live humble and faithful.

September 25th. Went to the semi-annual conference of the church at Salt Lake City accompanied by my wife, Mary Ann, and child and returned home on the 20th of October. Had a very enjoyable and prosperous time.

The numerous duties devolving upon me as Bishop in addition to having to farm my own land for a living for myself and family it seem'd impossible for me to find time to write a daily journal.